



Sharp AQUOS LC-15L1U-S

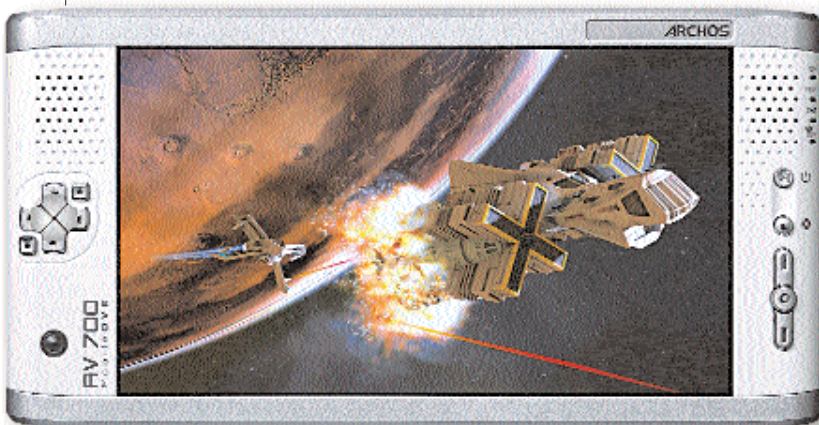
you'll have to cough up to own one of these.

Portable Media Players

Here, without a doubt, the iPod rules, whether it's video or audio that you're looking to play! Apple sure has taken the market by storm with its standard and Video iPod models, but that doesn't mean there aren't other options—especially if you want additional features and would like to try something different!

It's really hard to mention just one product in this segment, because each and every big manufacturer is offering so many models with features you never knew existed. That said, the personal favourite of this writer is the Archos AV 700. Here's why:

- ▣ 7-inch, 16:9 wide screen—480 x 234 pixel resolution
- ▣ 40 or 100 GB hard drive capacity
- ▣ Video recording capability—MPEG-4, up to 640 x 480 @ 30 fps



- ▣ Directly record from TV
- ▣ Music recording
- ▣ MP3 and WMA support
- ▣ Photo viewer (JPG / BMP)
- ▣ USB 2.0 port + USB host port to connect directly to a digital camera
- ▣ A/V out, earphone out
- ▣ Claimed 4 hour battery life with video, 30 hours* with audio
- ▣ Less than 600 grams ...and best of all
- ▣ The ability to play games using the Mophun gaming engine (visit www.mophun.com for a list of supported games)

Other devices such as the Creative Zen Vision and the Nokia 770 Internet Tablet are also good options for people with different needs. If you're looking for something smaller, the Zen Vision's 30 GB might be sufficient for you, and at only 240 grams, it's a lot lighter than the Archos. The Nokia Internet Tablet is for those who primarily want to surf and view multimedia content online, rather than saved content.

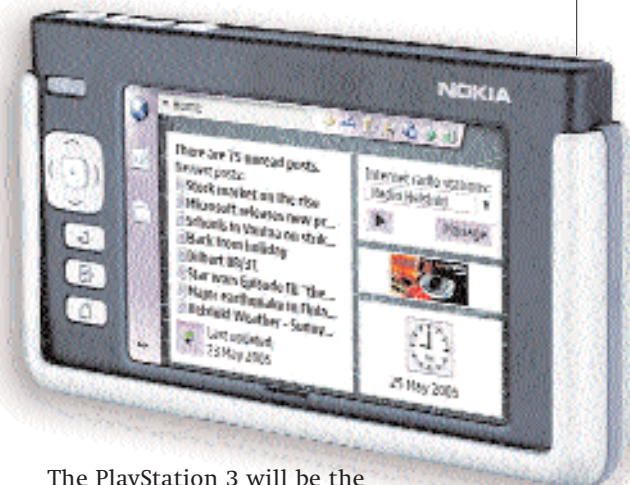
Gaming Consoles

There's a whole new market now for gaming consoles. Apart from first person shooter games, everything else is as fun and easy to play on consoles as on the PC. When you consider that the average console is cheaper than the latest top-of-the-line graphics card, forget about the rest of a PC—it all starts to make sense!

The Xbox 360 has been out for some time now, and it's by far the best console yet. However, it's in for some stiff competition from the Sony PS 3, which is scheduled to be released (finally) at the end of this year. Let's take

a look at some of the cool features the PS 3 promises:

- ▣ A Cell processor, running at 3.2 GHz
- ▣ 256 MB XDR RAM
- ▣ 256 MB GDDR3 RAM
- ▣ High definition output capable
- ▣ A gigabit Ethernet port, four USB 2.0 ports
- ▣ Bluetooth
- ▣ BD-ROM (Blu-ray disc ROM) drive
- ▣ Memory card readers (Secure Digital/CompactFlash/ MemoryStick)
- ▣ 20 or 60 GB SATA hard drive
- ▣ 5.1 Dolby audio output



The PlayStation 3 will be the most powerful gaming console when it is released, and it's no wonder that fans are impatiently awaiting its already-delayed launch. We'll have to do a head-to-head shootout of the Xbox 360 and PS 3, when we get our hands on both sometime in early 2007, to be able to tell you if the PS 3 really is as good as it sounds.

If you just cannot wait, go out and buy an Xbox 360 now—it's a magnificent console!

Buy, Buy, Buy

So whether it's gaming, movies, music, or television that is your poison, entertainment is guaranteed! With all the cool products vying for our attention, it's no wonder that the current generation is spending so much money. For those with nagging, frugal relatives, you can always use the popular excuse, "My bank balance may be nil, but at least I'm doing my bit to help the economy by spending!"

Just keep telling yourself that and buy, buy, buy! After all, you only live once! ■

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